TINY BEAD STUDIO

THE TINY BEAD PROFIT METHOD

BEAD JEWELRY YOU CAN SELL



The Tiny Bead Profit Method™

A Visual Step-by-Step Guide to Making Delicate Seed-Bead Jewelry and Turning It Into Extra Income

Welcome to Tiny Bead Studio. This is the main guide of your set: a calm, visual, step-by-step path from your very first bead to your first paid order.

You do not need experience, a studio or a big budget. You need a small kit, a little time each day, and the willingness to make a few crooked rows on the way to lovely ones.

Take your time, enjoy the process, and remember: every beautiful piece in your inspiration file started with one bead.

1. Welcome: How to Use This Guide



Welcome to Tiny Bead Studio, and to The Tiny Bead Profit Method™. If you have ever stood in front of a photo of a delicate beaded bracelet and thought, "I would love to make that, but where would I even start?" you are exactly who this guide was written for. You do not need artistic talent, expensive equipment or a free weekend. You need a small kit, a calm half hour, and a clear path to follow.

This guide is the main book in your set. It takes you from an empty table to your first finished bracelet, and then to your first paid order, in plain steps. It is built around three pillars, and every chapter supports at least one of them.

> **THE 3 PILLARS OF THE METHOD**
>
> Pillar 1, the best-seller radar: we point you toward the styles, sizes and color stories that people already buy, so you never spend weeks making something nobody wants. Pillar 2, the visual step-by-step path: every technique is broken into small rows and moves you can check against a chart. Pillar 3, your first paid order: a simple, honest plan for pricing, photographing and offering your pieces, so the hobby has a way to pay for itself if you want it to.

A word about expectations. Beading is a skill, and selling is a second skill. This guide gives you a map for both, but it cannot promise how fast or how much you will earn. Whenever we mention a price, it is a typical range that people list for similar pieces, offered as an example and not as a promise. Your results will depend on your skill, your time, your market and your effort.

Here is how the rest of your Tiny Bead Studio set fits together, so you always know where to look:

1. Welcome: How to Use This Guide (continued)

- This main guide: the full path from first bead to first order.
- The 50 Best-Selling Patterns collection: ready-to-follow charts you will use from Chapter 5 onward.
- The Design Templates and graph paper: blank grids so you can draw your own variations.
- The Price Calculator: the worksheet that goes with Chapter 13.
- The Supplier List: where to buy beads and findings, referred to in Chapters 3 and 4.
- The Photos That Sell guide: the companion to Chapter 14.
- From Jewelry to Your Own Small Business: the companion to Chapter 15.
- The Loom Technique guide: a second way of making flat pieces, in addition to the needle stitches taught here.
- The Fix-It troubleshooting guide: a longer version of the quick list in Chapter 16.

How to read this book. If you are brand new, read Chapters 1 to 6 in one or two sittings without beading, just to see the shape of the road. Then work through Chapters 7 to 10 with beads in your hands, one chapter per session. Chapters 11 to 15 are about earrings, colors, pricing, presenting and growing from one bracelet into a small collection and a small shop. Chapter 16 holds your 30-day plan and a quick troubleshooting list you can keep open next to your work.

> **TIP: USE THE BOXES**
>
> Throughout the guide you will see two kinds of boxes. Tip boxes hold small shortcuts that save beads, time or frustration. Practice task boxes give you one small, doable thing to try before you move on. Do the practice tasks. Reading about beadwork is pleasant, but your fingers learn it only by doing it.

Practice task: set your intention

Write one sentence on a sticky note: "In 30 days I want to have _____." It can be modest ("finished three bracelets and gifted them") or ambitious ("listed my first five pieces for sale"). Stick it where you will bead. You will come back to it in Chapter 16.

Finally, be kind to yourself. Every beader has a drawer of knotted thread and crooked first rows. Those are not failures, they are tuition. Take a breath, pour something warm to drink, and let us begin.

2. Why Delicate Seed-Bead Jewelry Sells



Walk through any craft fair, boutique or online marketplace and you will notice something: the pieces that make people slow down are often small. A slim woven cuff in soft colors, a pair of lightweight geometric earrings, a bracelet with a tiny pattern you have to look at twice. Delicate seed-bead jewelry has a quiet, handmade quality that mass-produced accessories rarely match, and that is a big part of why it keeps finding buyers.

Let us look at the reasons, because understanding them will help you decide what to make.

- It is wearable every day. Slim, light pieces suit work, errands and evenings out, so buyers do not feel they need a special occasion.
- It looks complex but is built from simple moves. A pattern that appears intricate is usually the same stitch repeated with color changes, which means you can learn it quickly and still make something impressive.
- It is personal. Buyers love colors chosen for them, a birthday month palette, a favorite team, a wedding color. Small custom touches are easy with beads.
- It is a perfect gift. A bracelet fits in a small box, ships cheaply and does not require guessing a size as precisely as a ring does.
- Materials are compact and inexpensive. A few tubes of beads produce several pieces, so your cost per piece can stay low.

The best-seller radar, pillar one of the method, is a habit more than a gadget. Once a week, spend ten minutes looking at what is listed and what seems to be selling in the styles you like: the color combinations that appear again and again, the sizes, the price tags, the way sellers name their pieces. You are not copying anyone. You are noticing patterns, in the same way a florist notices which flowers are in season. The 50 Best-Selling Patterns collection that comes with this guide was assembled with exactly this lens: classic, repeatable designs in colorways people tend to choose.

> **TIP: THREE QUESTIONS BEFORE YOU MAKE ANYTHING**
>
> Would someone wear this to work or to coffee? Can I make a second one in a different color without redesigning it? Can I describe it in one short sentence? If you can answer yes three times, the design is a good candidate for your small collection.

2. Why Delicate Seed-Bead Jewelry Sells (continued)

It also helps to be honest about the other side. Delicate beadwork takes patience, and your time is part of the price. The goal of this method is not to make you a factory. It is to help you make a handful of lovely, repeatable pieces well, so that every hour at the table is enjoyable and worthwhile.

What buyers often value	What it means for you
Handmade look	Do not fear tiny imperfections. Even tension matters more than perfection.
Comfort	Soft thread, smooth finishing and the right length beat fancy decoration.
Color harmony	Fewer, well-chosen colors beat a rainbow (see Chapter 12).
Giftability	Good packaging and a short care card raise how special a piece feels.
Story	A name and one sentence about the inspiration help a piece stand out.

Practice task: start your inspiration file

Create a folder on your phone or a page in a notebook. Save or sketch five bracelets or earrings you find beautiful, and under each write one reason you like it (color, shape, simplicity). Do not worry about whether you can make them yet. This file becomes your personal radar.

3. The Starter Kit: Tools, Materials and Budget Tiers



The good news about seed beading is that the toolkit is small. You can start with items from a craft store or an online order and add better supplies later when you know what you enjoy. Here is what you truly need, what is nice to have, and three budget tiers so you can match the kit to your wallet. All amounts are examples in US dollars; prices and stock change, so check before ordering. The Supplier List in your set shows where to look.

The essentials, in order of importance:

- Beads: Miyuki Delica 11/0 cylinder beads are the most beginner-friendly for flat, even pieces. Round 11/0 seed beads are also lovely and Toho is a good alternative brand.
- Thread: nylon beading thread such as size D, or a braided fused line around 6 to 8 lb test. Nylon is soft and forgiving. Fused line is strong and does not fray.
- Needles: beading needles size 11 to 13. Size 12 is a comfortable starting point for 11/0 beads. Buy a pack, because they bend and disappear.
- Scissors: small, sharp ones. Embroidery scissors work well.
- Bead mat or tray: a piece of felt, a rubber mat or a shallow dish stops beads rolling.
- Findings: clasps, jump rings, ear wires or posts, crimp tubes and wire guardians for finishing (Chapter 9).
- Basic pliers: flat-nose and round-nose pliers for jump rings and findings.
- Light: a bright daylight lamp. Good light protects your eyes and makes color mistakes easy to catch.

Nice to have, but not on day one: a magnifier or head-mounted lamp, a thread conditioner or beeswax block for nylon thread, a needle threader, a bead spinner, a hand-held bead scoop and a project box with dividers.

3. The Starter Kit: Tools, Materials and Budget Tiers (continued)

Item	$30 starter	$60 steady	$100 studio
Beads	3 to 4 tubes or small bags of Delica 11/0 in a tight palette	8 to 10 colors in small tubes, plus a few round 11/0 for accents	Two full palettes, some 15/0 and 8/0 for variety, plus metallic accent colors
Thread	1 spool nylon D	1 spool nylon D and 1 spool braided line	Both, plus a second color of each
Needles	1 pack size 12	Size 12 and 13 assorted	Assorted pack plus a needle threader
Tools	Scissors, felt square, small dish	Flat-nose and round-nose pliers, bead mat	Better pliers, magnifier lamp, project case
Findings	2 lobster clasps, a few jump rings	Clasps, ear wires, crimp tubes, wire guardians	Wider assortment in silver tone and gold tone
Good for	Trying the craft and making 2 to 3 pieces	Making a small set of pieces to gift or sell	Serving first customers with variety

> **TIP: BUY A PALETTE, NOT A PILE**
> Instead of buying 30 random colors, pick one palette of 4 to 6 colors that look beautiful together and buy those. A small set of harmonious beads gets you a finished piece faster, and finished pieces keep you motivated. Chapter 12 shows six palettes that sell.

A note on cost control. Many people overbuy in week one and then freeze, because they feel they need to "use it all properly." Resist. Seed beads do not expire, so you can always buy more. Start small, finish something, then expand. If your budget is tight, the $30 tier genuinely is enough for the first bracelet and a pair of earrings.

Practice task: build your shopping list

Using the table above, choose your tier. Write the list with quantities and a rough price next to each line. Add the total to your sticky note from Chapter 1. If you already own supplies, tick them off first so you only buy what is missing.

4. Understanding Beads: Types, Sizes, Finishes and Buying Without Waste



Beads look simple until you stand in front of a wall of tiny tubes. This chapter gives you the vocabulary to choose confidently. You will learn the difference between Delica cylinders and round seed beads, what the numbers mean, how finishes change the look of a piece, and how to buy the right quantity so you do not run out halfway through a bracelet or end up with a drawer of leftovers.

Delica versus round. Miyuki Delica 11/0 beads are cylinders with large holes and very thin, even walls. Because they are uniform, they sit side by side like tiny bricks and create flat, smooth fabric, which is why many charts for woven pieces are written for them. Round seed beads, such as Miyuki round 11/0, are shaped like small donuts. They sit with a slightly rounded, textured surface and are lovely for edging, fringe and a more traditional look. Toho makes comparable beads and is a good alternative if a color is out of stock. Different brands vary slightly in size, so avoid mixing brands inside one flat piece.

Bead type	Approx. size	Approx. beads per inch laid side by side	Best for
Round 8/0	about 3 mm	about 8	Chunky accents, bold edging, beginner-friendly handling
Round 11/0	about 2 mm	about 12	Fringe, edging, textured bracelets
Delica 11/0	about 1.6 mm	about 16	Flat woven pieces from charts, peyote, brick, square stitch
Round 15/0	about 1.5 mm	about 17	Very fine detail, delicate earrings, edging

These figures are approximate. Every manufacturing lot varies a little, so treat the numbers as planning tools and always check the label. The "11/0" is an old sizing system: the larger the number before the slash, the smaller the bead. Think of it as roughly how many beads would fit across an inch, with the real number a little different.

Finishes change the personality of a piece. The most common ones are:

4. Understanding Beads: Types, Sizes, Finishes and Buying Without Waste (continued)

- Opaque: solid color, easy to see and a great place to start. Opaque beads also hide the thread.
- Transparent and translucent: let light through, so colors look glassy and bright. The thread color can show, so use thread close to the bead color.
- Matte: a soft, frosted look that feels modern and calm. Matte colors often sell well in neutral palettes.
- Metallic and galvanized: a shiny, mirror-like finish that adds a gold, silver or bronze accent. Some finishes can wear with heavy use, so keep them as accents.
- AB (aurora borealis): a rainbow shimmer over a base color, wonderful for evening pieces.
- Lined and color-lined: a colored lining inside a clear bead, giving depth and glow.
- Ceylon and luster: a soft, pearly sheen.

Color families. Instead of thinking of every bead as a separate color, group them into families: neutrals (cream, taupe, charcoal, black, white), warm (reds, oranges, golden yellows, coral), cool (blues, teals, greens, lavender), and metallics (gold, silver, copper, bronze). A pattern usually works best with colors from one or two families plus a metallic or neutral accent.

How to buy without waste. Beads are sold by the gram, by the tube, or by the hank. For a first bracelet you need a surprisingly small amount. A simple way to estimate is to use the bead-count method: multiply the number of beads across the width by the number of rows per inch, then by the length in inches, then add 10 percent for losses and mistakes. The table below shows planning figures for Delica 11/0, which sit 16 beads per inch in a row.

Piece	Width (beads)	Length	Approx. beads needed (with 10% spare)
Slim bracelet	6	7 in (about 18 cm)	about 6 x 112 = 672, so plan on about 740
Standard bracelet	10	7 in	about 10 x 112 = 1,120, so plan on about 1,230
Wide cuff	16	7 in	about 16 x 112 = 1,792, so plan on about 1,970
Pair of drop earrings	8 x 20 rows	each	about 160 each, 320 per pair, plan on about 350

A typical tube or small bag of Delica 11/0 holds several hundred to a few thousand beads depending on the packaging, so a single color often goes a long way. Check the quantity on the label. One tube of the main color and a smaller amount of the accents is usually enough for your first bracelet.

> **TIP: BUY THE DOMINANT COLOR ONCE, ACCENTS TWICE**
> If you love a pattern, the dominant color (the background) is the one you will run out of. Buy a bit more of it than you think you need. Accent colors are used sparingly, so a small bag lasts for several pieces.

> **TIP: ALWAYS BUY FROM ONE LOT**
> Colors from different production lots can look slightly different. If you are making a set, such as a bracelet and matching earrings, buy all the beads for the set at once, or keep leftovers labeled by lot so you can match them.

5. Reading Bead Charts and Graph Paper

A chart is simply a picture of a finished piece, drawn on a grid so you can see which color goes where. Once you can read one, you can follow any pattern in the world, including the 50 Best-Selling Patterns that come with this guide. This chapter shows you how to read charts in the three most common formats, and how our patterns and templates are organized.

Every cell is a bead. A chart is a grid of colored squares or small shapes. Each cell represents one bead. The colors are numbered or lettered, and a key (or legend) tells you which bead color each number means. A good habit is to place your real beads next to the chart and label each pile with the same number or letter.

Three chart formats you will meet:

- Loom and square-stitch charts: a plain grid of squares, one square per bead, laid out exactly as the bead sits in the finished piece. Rows run across, columns run down. These are the easiest to read because what you see is what you stitch.
- Peyote charts: because peyote beads sit offset, half a bead up or down from their neighbors, the grid is drawn with every other column shifted, in a brick-like layout. Each row has half as many beads as the two rows it sits between would suggest.
- Brick-stitch charts: also drawn with an offset, but the offset runs horizontally, like bricks in a wall, with each row staggered.

Which direction do I read? For flat woven pieces, you generally start at the bottom of the chart and read up, or at the top and read down, depending on the pattern. Our patterns state the start point and direction at the top of every chart. For peyote, each row alternates direction: you read left to right, then right to left, then left to right again. A small arrow beside each row in our charts reminds you.

> **HOW OUR 50 PATTERNS WORK**
> Each pattern in the collection includes a numbered color key, the chart drawn in the correct grid for its stitch (loom, peyote or square-stitch), the finished width and length in beads and in inches, an estimate of bead counts per color, and the recommended palette. If a pattern is written for peyote and you prefer square stitch, the Design Templates show you how to redraw it. The patterns are original charts made for this set, written so you can follow them step by step.

Using graph paper and templates. The Design Templates in your set give you blank grids for loom or square stitch, peyote and brick stitch, plus ruled versions for bracelets and earrings. Use colored pencils or markers to fill in cells. A good first exercise is to color a simple stripe or a zigzag, because you can count it row by row and see exactly how many beads of each color you need.

Chart type	Grid shape	Rows alternate direction?	Best first project
Loom or square stitch	Plain square grid	No (square stitch is worked row by row, loom is worked across)	Simple striped or checkered bracelet
Even-count peyote	Offset columns	Yes, left to right then right to left	Slim zigzag bracelet

5. Reading Bead Charts and Graph Paper (continued)

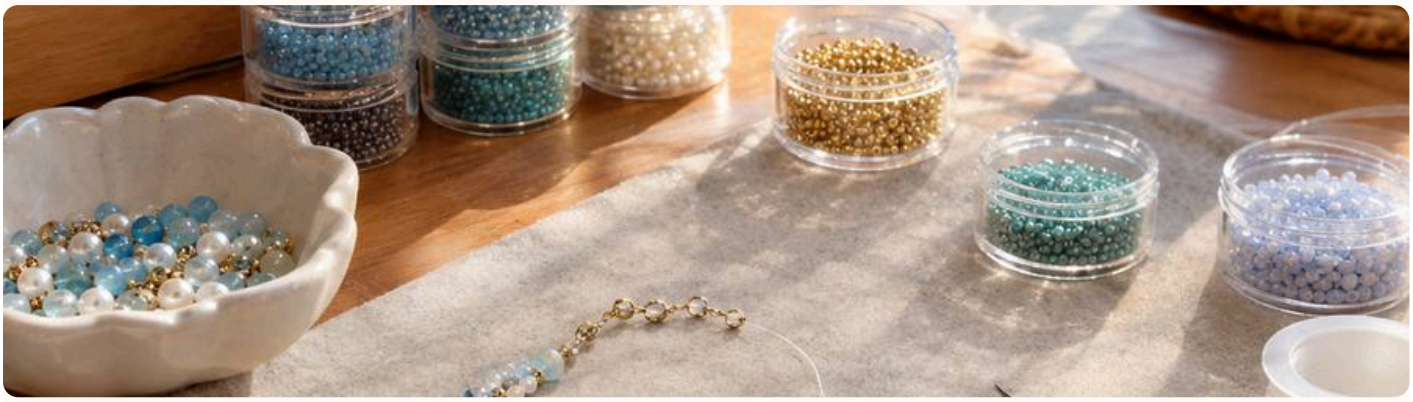
Reading a repeat. Most designs are built from a repeat, a small block of rows that is stitched again and again. Find the repeat in the chart, count its beads, and you can work from memory after the first pass. This also lets you adjust the length of a bracelet: more repeats means longer, fewer means shorter.

> **TIP: COPY AND ENLARGE**
>
> If a chart is small, enlarge it when printing and put it in a clear sleeve. You can then use a dry-erase marker to cross off rows as you go and erase later, keeping the original clean for future pieces.

Practice task: read a chart aloud

Choose a small pattern from the collection or the templates. Without beading, say aloud, row by row, which colors appear, from left to right. For example: "Row 1: dark, dark, light, light, dark, dark." Do this for five rows. If you can describe rows aloud, your fingers will find the stitching simple.

6. Setting Up: Thread, Needles, Tension, Workspace and Comfort



The difference between an enjoyable beading session and a frustrating one often comes down to setup. A well-prepared table, a correctly cut length of thread and a relaxed hand are worth more than any technique. This chapter covers the small decisions that make everything else easier.

Choosing and cutting thread. Nylon beading thread in size D is a friendly choice for 11/0 beads, as is a braided fused line around 6 to 8 lb test. Nylon is soft and drapes nicely, but can stretch and fray; braided line is stronger and does not stretch, but can feel stiff at first. For bracelets, cut about 4 to 5 feet (roughly 1.2 to 1.5 m) at a time. That sounds long, but it gives you room to weave without adding thread too early. Longer than 6 feet will tangle.

Conditioning. Running nylon thread through a block of beeswax or a thread conditioner makes it slide more smoothly and reduces knotting. Pull the thread through the block once or twice, then pinch it between your fingers to remove excess. Do not over-wax, because wax can build up and attract fuzz.

Threading the needle. Moisten the end of the thread a little if you wish, flatten it between your fingertips, and pass it through the needle eye. If the eye is too small, trim the end at an angle for a clean cut. A needle threader helps. Pull about 6 inches of tail through, because you do not need to double the thread for the stitches in this guide.

Choosing the right needle. A size 12 needle suits 11/0 Delica beads, since Delica holes are large. Size 13 is finer and good for 15/0 beads and for pieces where you pass through the same bead many times. Bent needles should be replaced; a straight needle is a quiet joy.

> **TENSION: THE HEART OF BEADWORK**
> Tension is how firmly you pull the thread after each stitch. Too loose and the fabric is floppy with visible thread. Too tight and the piece is stiff and buckles. The goal is snug but not strangled: when you pull the thread gently, the beads should sit flush against each other with no gaps, and the piece should still bend gently like cloth. Practice by pulling after each stitch with the same small, steady motion.

6. Setting Up: Thread, Needles, Tension, Workspace and Comfort (continued)

- Hold the work between your thumb and index finger of your non-dominant hand.
- Pull the thread parallel to the row, not upward, to avoid distorting the beads.
- After every row, run your fingertip along the edge: it should feel smooth, not bumpy.
- If you notice loose spots, correct them right away on the next row by gently pulling the thread through in small steps.

Stop beads and tails. Leave a tail of at least 6 inches at the beginning. Some beaders put a stop bead on the end of the thread, a bead pinned in place by looping through it twice, to stop the first beads sliding off. Remove the stop bead once the first row is secure. Later, weave in the tail by passing the needle back through several beads and tiny turns, then trim close.

Workspace and ergonomics. Work at a table with your forearms supported and your shoulders relaxed. A light-colored bead mat helps you see tiny beads, but a dark bead on a dark mat is invisible, so use a mat that contrasts with your palette. Good light, a lamp beside your non-dominant side to avoid shadows, and a chair that supports your back make long sessions kinder to your body.

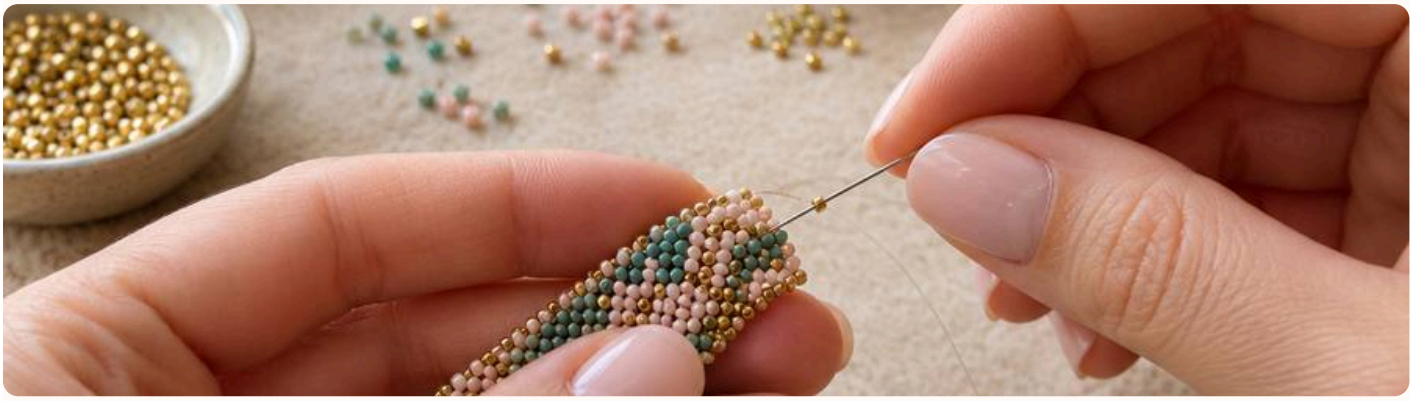
Comfort habit	How often	Why
Look up and focus on something far away	Every 15 minutes	Rests your eyes from close work
Roll your shoulders and shake out your hands	Every 20 to 30 minutes	Prevents stiffness
Stand up and stretch	Every 45 to 60 minutes	Keeps circulation moving
Drink water	Each session	Easy to forget when absorbed

> **TIP: KEEP A BEAD DISH WITH A LIP**
> Pour beads into a shallow dish rather than working straight from the tube. A dish with a lip lets you scoop them onto the needle. Keep a lid or a cloth handy in case of spills, and set your dish on a non-slip mat.

Practice task: thread and tension drill

Cut 4 feet of thread, thread your needle, and string 20 beads of a single color. Slide them down, pull gently, and check that they sit snug. Then pass the needle back through the beads in the other direction, gently, and pull again. You have practiced the two movements that nearly every stitch uses: picking up beads and passing back through them.

7. Ladder, Brick and Square Stitch



Before peyote, three foundations will make you a stronger beader. Ladder stitch creates a base row. Brick stitch grows rows from that base. Square stitch builds a neat grid where each bead sits exactly above another, which is why it pairs so naturally with charts. In this chapter you will learn the basic motion of each. Take them slowly; each one is a very small idea.

Ladder stitch. Think of ladder stitch as a way of joining beads side by side, like the rungs of a ladder lying on the table. It gives you a stable first row for brick stitch, and it can also create a very slim strap on its own.

- Pick up two beads (call them A and B) and slide them to within 6 inches of the tail.
- Pass the needle down through bead A (the first one you picked up) and then back up through bead B, so the thread makes a loop and the two beads sit side by side. Pull snug.
- Pick up one more bead (C). Pass the needle down through B, then back up through C, and pull snug. Each new bead is attached to the one before it by a loop through both.
- Repeat, always going down through the previous bead and up through the new one, until you have the number of beads your pattern needs.
- For extra strength, zigzag the thread back along the strip once, passing through each bead in turn. Your ladder is now a stable flat strip.

Brick stitch. Brick stitch is worked row by row on top of a ladder base. The key idea is that each new bead is attached to a loop of thread that sits between two beads of the row below, like a brick in a wall resting on the mortar between two bricks below it.

- Start with a ladder base, with the thread emerging from the last bead.
- Pick up two beads. Pass the needle under the first thread bridge between the last two beads of the base (counting from the end where you started), then back up through the second bead you picked up, and pull snug.
- For each next stitch, pick up one bead, pass the needle under the next thread bridge in the row below, and back up through the new bead.
- At the end of the row, secure with a small turn, and repeat for the next row. Each row has one fewer bead than the row below if you want a triangle; keep the count constant for a rectangular piece.

7. Ladder, Brick and Square Stitch (continued)

> **TIP: TUG UPWARD, NOT SIDEWAYS**
> In brick stitch the thread bridge can be hidden. When you pull, pull upward in the direction of the bead you just added. This sets the bead straight and keeps the rows even.

Square stitch. Square stitch puts beads exactly on top of each other, making a grid that matches a square-cell chart one-to-one. It is sturdy, a little slower than peyote, and ideal for designs with sharp corners and straight lines, such as a diamond or initial.

- String the first row: pick up as many beads as the pattern's width (for a 6-bead-wide bracelet, six beads). Slide them to within 6 inches of the tail. This is row one; the thread exits the last bead.
- Row two begins: pick up two beads. Skip the last bead of row one, pass the needle back through the second-to-last bead of row one, and then up through the second new bead. Pull snug. The two new beads now sit directly above the last two beads of row one.
- For each next stitch, pick up one bead, pass the needle through the next bead of row one (working back toward the tail), and then back up through the bead you just added. Pull so the new bead sits above the one below and snug against its neighbor.
- At the end of the row, pass the needle through the whole row of new beads once to lock them together, then turn to start the next row.
- Row three builds on row two the same way. Keep tension even, and check after each row that the beads form straight vertical columns.

Stitch	Looks like	Strength	Good for	Speed for beginners
Ladder	Flat strip of side-by-side beads	Strong at the thread passes	Base rows, slim straps	Fast
Brick	Staggered rows like brickwork	Medium, flexible	Earrings, small shapes, triangles	Medium
Square	Perfect grid	Very sturdy	Charts with sharp lines, initials	Slower, very precise

> **TIP: PICK THE STITCH FOR THE CHART**
> If a chart is a plain grid, square stitch matches it exactly. If you love the flexible drape of peyote but have a square chart, the Design Templates in your set show you how to redraw it for peyote.

Practice task: three tiny samples

Make a ladder of 8 beads, a 3-row brick sample on top of a 6-bead ladder, and a 6-bead-wide, 4-row square-stitch sample. Use two contrasting colors so you can see the structure. Keep them in a small bag; they become your reference swatches.

8. Even-Count Peyote, Step by Step

Peyote stitch is the workhorse of delicate seed-bead jewelry. It is flexible, light, quick and forgiving, and it produces the beautiful offset texture you see in many woven bracelets. Even-count peyote means the first two rows together use an even number of beads, which makes the turns at the end of each row the easiest to learn. We will work a sample 12 beads wide at the start (6 beads per row). Use Delica 11/0 in two contrasting colors, A (dark) and B (light), so you can see every move.

How peyote works in one sentence: each new bead sits in the gap between two beads of the row below, and you stitch by skipping a bead, then passing through the next. Every row you add makes the fabric grow by a half-step, which is why the beads look offset.

> **TIP: BEFORE YOU START**
> Use a thread length of about 4 feet and a size 12 needle. Leave a tail of 6 inches. Place a stop bead only if you find the first beads slide away; most beginners find it helpful. Work over a bead mat with good light.

Rows 1 and 2 (the base). These two rows are strung together as one set of beads, and they create the zigzag foundation.

- String 12 beads, alternating A and B: A, B, A, B, A, B, A, B, A, B, A, B. Slide them down to within 6 inches of the tail. Count them twice. These 12 beads form rows 1 and 2 together: the beads in odd positions (1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11) will become the lower row, and the beads in even positions will become the upper row after row 3.
- The thread exits bead 12, the one nearest the needle.

Row 3 (the first true row of new beads). This is where you meet the central move of peyote.

- Pick up one bead (color A). Skip bead 12 and pass the needle through bead 11 (the second-to-last bead), moving in the direction of the tail. Pull the thread; the new bead should now sit snugly next to bead 12, like a little step up.
- Pick up another bead. Skip bead 10 and go through bead 9. Pull snug.
- Repeat: pick up one bead, skip one bead, pass through the next. You will skip beads 12, 10, 8, 6, 4 and 2, and pass through beads 11, 9, 7, 5, 3 and 1. You add 6 new beads in total.
- After the last stitch your thread exits bead 1. Look at your work: you should see a zigzag with new beads sitting up between the original beads.

> **CHECK YOUR ROW**
> After row 3, count: there should be 6 beads sitting "up" (the new row) and 6 beads sitting "down" (the original odd-numbered beads) with the skipped beads in between. If your count is off, undo the last stitches and recount. Catching a mistake now saves an entire row later.

Row 4 and the turn. At the end of a row, the thread points away from the work. Here is the turn, which feels awkward only the first time.

8. Even-Count Peyote, Step by Step (continued)

- Pick up one bead. Pass the needle through the nearest raised bead of row 3 (the one next to where the thread exits), pulling in the direction that leads back along the row. Pull snug so the new bead sits at the edge next to the old one.
- Pick up another bead and pass through the next raised bead of row 3. In peyote, each new bead goes into the gap, resting between two raised beads. You are adding a bead above each raised bead, in a staggered way.
- Continue until you reach the end of the row. In the first few rows you will see the edge bead is added first and then the others fill in. At the end, your thread exits the last raised bead on the other side.

Step up and keep going. Every row after this is the same two moves: pick up a bead, pass through the next raised bead. The only difference is the direction. Row 5 runs back in the opposite direction, row 6 forward again. Each time you reach the end, the thread naturally exits the edge bead and is ready for the next row. After about 6 rows, you will see the classic peyote pattern: raised beads on one side lining up with gaps on the other. If you pull too tightly, the edge curls; if you pull too loosely, you see thread. Aim for a small, even tug.

Row	What you do	Result
1 and 2	String 12 beads (alternating A, B)	Foundation zigzag
3	Add a bead, skip one, go through the next; repeat 6 times	6 raised beads
4	Add a bead above each raised bead, working back along the row	6 beads in a new row
5	Same as row 4, in the opposite direction	Fabric grows
6 and up	Repeat	Continue to the length required

Counting rows. In peyote, you count the raised beads on one edge. Each raised bead along the edge equals two rows, one on each side of the fabric. If your pattern says 40 rows, count 20 raised beads on one edge. Place a small sticky note to mark every 10 rows.

Changing colors. In a chart, a color change is just a matter of picking up a different color bead for that stitch. The thread path does not change. Keep the beads you need next to each other in your dish so you can pick them up in order.

Adding a new thread. When your thread has about 5 inches left, stop. Tie a small half-hitch knot between two beads, pass the needle through a few beads, and trim. Start the new thread by weaving through four or five beads in a zigzag, tying a small half-hitch knot, then continue in the same direction. Neat and tucked, the join disappears.

> **TIP: ODD-COUNT PEYOTE**
> In odd-count peyote the turn at the end of the row is trickier, because you must make a small extra loop around the edge bead. This guide keeps even-count for your first pieces. When you want an odd count, for patterns with a single center line, the Design Templates in your set show the extra turn.

9. Finishing: Clasps, Crimps, Wire Guardians, Sizing and Earring Findings



A piece is not finished when the last row is done. Finishing is what turns a woven strip into a bracelet someone can wear and trust. This chapter shows you how to measure, choose findings and attach them safely, with charts you can come back to.

Step 1: size first. Measure the wrist snugly with a flexible tape or a strip of paper, then add allowance for comfort and clasp length. For a bracelet that sits close, add about 1/2 inch; for a comfortable fit, 1 inch; for a loose, flowing fit, 1.5 inches. Remember the clasp itself takes up some length (usually 1/2 to 3/4 inch for a lobster clasp with a jump ring), so subtract that from the woven length.

Wrist measurement	Snug fit (+1/2 in)	Comfortable (+1 in)	Loose (+1.5 in)
5.5 in (14 cm)	6 in	6.5 in	7 in
6 in (15 cm)	6.5 in	7 in	7.5 in
6.5 in (16.5 cm)	7 in	7.5 in	8 in
7 in (18 cm)	7.5 in	8 in	8.5 in
7.5 in (19 cm)	8 in	8.5 in	9 in
8 in (20 cm)	8.5 in	9 in	9.5 in

These are total finished lengths including the clasp. For a woven bracelet, subtract the clasp length to get the number of beaded rows. Delica 11/0 in peyote gives about 16 rows per inch along the length, but check your own tension by counting the rows in a measured inch of your sample.

Necklace style	Typical length	Where it sits
Choker	14 to 16 in (35 to 40 cm)	At the base of the neck
Princess	17 to 19 in (43 to 48 cm)	Collarbone
Matinee	20 to 24 in (50 to 60 cm)	Above the bust
Opera	28 to 36 in (70 to 90 cm)	At or below the bust

Findings explained.

9. Finishing: Clasps, Crimps, Wire Guardians, Sizing and Earring Findings (continued)

- Lobster clasp and jump ring: the most common closure. Attach the jump ring to the end loop of your piece, and the lobster to the opposite end with another ring or a short chain for adjustment.
- Toggle clasp: a ring and bar that hook together. Looks pretty, easy for people with stiff hands.
- Magnetic clasp: easy to fasten with one hand. Choose a strong one and avoid it for people with pacemakers or similar concerns.
- Crimp tubes and crimp covers: small metal tubes you flatten to secure the end of a thread or wire, then cover.
- Wire guardians: small wire loops that protect the thread where it meets a clasp, reducing wear.
- Jump rings: small open rings; open them sideways with two pliers, never outward, so the ring keeps its shape.
- Ear wires, posts and hoops: attach the beaded piece to a ring or loop on the finding. For sensitive ears, look for hypoallergenic materials and say so honestly in your listing.

Attaching a clasp to a woven strip. Weave the end thread back through the final row to exit the last bead at the end. Pick up a few seed beads, a small loop of 3 to 5 beads for a jump ring or clasp, then pass back through the end beads of the strip. Go through the loop twice for strength, and weave the thread back into the piece with half-hitch knots. Trim the tail close to the beads.

> **TIP: TEST EVERY CLOSURE**
> Before you pass a piece on, gently tug the clasp, then tug the strip. Hold the bracelet at both ends and give a firm but gentle pull. If anything moves, add another pass of thread. A safe closure is the difference between a lovely gift and a lost bracelet.

> **TIP: KEEP AN HONEST CARE CARD**
> A small card with the line "Please avoid water, perfume and rough contact; store flat in a dry place" helps your pieces last. Add it to every package.

Practice task: add a clasp to your sampler

Take the peyote sampler from Chapter 8. Make a thread loop at one end and attach a jump ring, then attach a lobster clasp at the other end with another loop. Tug it firmly. If it holds, you have your first finished sample bracelet.

10. Your First Bracelet: A Full Walkthrough



It is time to make something wearable. This walkthrough is a slim peyote bracelet in a simple zigzag, the kind of design beginners often finish in a few evenings. We will describe the chart in words so you can follow without a printout, and you will find a similar chart in the Design Templates and the 50 patterns.

What you will need. About 740 Delica 11/0 beads, split roughly as follows: 450 of the main color (call it A, a soft cream), 220 of the accent (call it B, a muted teal) and 70 of a metallic gold (call it C) for a thin line. A lobster clasp, two jump rings, thread (size D nylon or 6 lb fused line), a size 12 needle, scissors and a bead mat.

Part	Value
Width	6 beads per row (12 across the first two rows)
Pattern	Zigzag with cream background, teal zigzag, thin gold accent
Woven length	About 6.5 inches (roughly 104 rows)
Finished length	About 7 inches with the clasp for a 6-inch wrist (comfortable fit)
Time	About 6 to 10 hours, depending on pace

Reading the chart in words. Imagine a grid with 6 raised beads across. For rows 1 and 2, alternate cream and teal. In the first group of 8 rows, the teal beads sit on the left half of the row and the cream on the right. Every 8 rows, the teal moves one bead to the right, until it reaches the right edge, and then it moves back toward the left. This makes a gentle zigzag stripe. Every 16 rows, one gold bead appears at the center of the row to add a tiny sparkle. Repeat the 32-row block until you reach the length you want.

10. Your First Bracelet: A Full Walkthrough (continued)

- Step 1: Set up. Cut 4 feet of thread, thread the needle, put a stop bead on the tail if you like.
- Step 2: String rows 1 and 2. Pick up 12 beads in the zigzag start pattern (cream, teal alternating, with the first three teal beads on the left).
- Step 3: Work rows 3 to 8 following the chart in words, remembering that you pick up one bead, skip one, go through the next. Use your fingertip to check the edge.
- Step 4: Continue the zigzag block. Every row, glance at the chart, say the color order aloud, and pick up beads in that order.
- Step 5: Add thread when needed. When you have about 5 inches left, tie a half-hitch knot between two beads, weave through a few beads, trim, and start a fresh length in the same way.
- Step 6: Measure. After about 80 rows, lay the strip against your wrist or against a measuring tape. Finish when the woven length equals your target, minus the clasp length.
- Step 7: Finish the ends. Add loops for the jump rings (Chapter 9), attach the clasp, weave in the tails, and tug test.

> **TIP: SET SMALL GOALS**
> Beading 100 rows in one sitting is not the goal. Aim for 10 rows at a time. Place a sticky note on the chart every time you stop, so you resume exactly where you left off.

> **TIP: IF YOU RUN OUT OF A COLOR**
> Do not panic. Place the order with the supplier and mention the lot code if you have it. Or switch to a similar color for the accent in the remaining zigzag; handmade pieces often look more charming with a tiny variation.

Check, wash and wear. When it is done, hold the bracelet up to the light and look for any spots where thread shows or beads sit crooked. A gentle pull on both ends and on the clasp tells you if it is secure. Try it on, and take a photograph while the piece is new. This is the first piece in your portfolio.

Practice task: make the bracelet

Set a calendar reminder for three sessions of 45 to 60 minutes. Session one: rows 1 to 30. Session two: rows 31 to 80. Session three: the remaining rows and finishing. Tick each off when you are done. Take a photo and write the date on the back of the photo.

- Checklist: before you start, you have your beads counted, your needle and thread ready, your chart marked up, your clasp and jump rings ready, and your care card printed.
- Checklist: before you finish, your length matches the wrist, your edge feels smooth, the closure passes the tug test, and you have photographed the piece.

11. Earrings, Rings and Matching Sets: How to Scale a Pattern



One of the most satisfying moments in beadwork is realizing that a bracelet pattern is also an earring pattern, a ring pattern and a bookmark pattern. Scaling a pattern is less about math and more about thinking in blocks. This chapter shows you how to shrink, stretch and combine patterns so one design becomes a matching set.

The scaling idea. A pattern is a grid of beads. If you take the same grid but cut it to a smaller width and fewer rows, you get a smaller piece. The motifs repeat, so you can choose which part of the repeat to keep.

Piece	Typical width (beads)	Typical rows	Approx. size	Notes
Slim bracelet	6	100 to 120	6.5 to 7.5 in	Peyote or square stitch
Wide cuff	12 to 16	100 to 120	6.5 to 7.5 in	Needs sturdy thread
Drop earrings	6 to 8	18 to 24	about 1 to 1.5 in drop	Light, uses little thread
Studs or small statement	5 to 6	10 to 14	about 0.5 to 0.8 in	Quick to make
Band ring	6	about 60 to 70	fit to finger	Measure finger size
Bookmark	8 to 10	200 to 280	about 4 to 7 in	Great gift

Earrings from a bracelet pattern. Choose one repeat of the bracelet (say, 24 rows). Stitch it as it is, then attach an ear wire at the top. If the repeat has a motif that finishes in the middle, add a few plain rows at the top and bottom for a neat shape. For a matching pair, make two pieces that mirror each other or two identical pieces; a mirror pair looks more elegant.

- Pick the 24 to 30 rows you like best from the bracelet pattern.
- Stitch it in peyote at the same width or reduce to 4 or 5 beads wide.
- Add a 3-bead loop at the top for the ear wire, attaching it with a jump ring.
- Make the second earring, comparing it to the first as you go. Count rows rather than eyeballing it.
- Weigh or hold them side by side. Delicate earrings should feel light on the ear.

11. Earrings, Rings and Matching Sets: How to Scale a Pattern (continued)

Rings. A beaded ring band is a strip woven to the finger's measurement and joined end to end. Measure the finger with a paper strip, mark where it overlaps, and add a small allowance. Weave the strip until it matches the measured length, then join the two ends with a zipper pass: thread the needle through the end beads of both ends alternately, as if closing a zipper. Wearing beaded rings in water shortens their life, so mention that in the care card.

Matching sets. A set is the same color story and motif in three sizes: a bracelet, a pair of earrings and a small ring or a necklace. Buyers love sets because they feel complete and they are a natural way to raise the order value. Plan the set before buying beads, so all the pieces share a lot.

> **TIP: ALWAYS KEEP A MASTER CHART**
> Copy the original pattern, then mark where you cut it for the earrings or the ring. This lets you recreate a set months later, matching the exact rows.

> **TIP: SMALLER IS NOT ALWAYS FASTER**
> Small pieces use fewer beads but need finer finishing. A pair of earrings may take as long as a slim bracelet when you count the attachments. Include this in the price (Chapter 13).

Set	Pieces	Approx. beads (Delica 11/0)	Approx. time
Essentials set	Slim bracelet + drop earrings	about 1,050	8 to 12 hours
Gift set	Bracelet + earrings + ring	about 1,300	10 to 15 hours
Mini set	Studs + ring	about 350	3 to 5 hours

Practice task: design a mini set

On graph paper from the Design Templates, take your first bracelet pattern and mark one 24-row block for earrings. Count the beads of each color for the pair. Write the count on the chart. If you feel ready, stitch one earring as a test.

12. Color Palettes That Sell



Color is the first thing a buyer notices and the quickest way to make a piece feel professional. The good news is that you do not need a trained eye. You need a few reliable rules and a handful of palettes you trust. This chapter gives you both.

> **THE 60-30-10 RULE**
> Use one dominant color for about 60 percent of the piece, a supporting color for about 30 percent, and an accent for about 10 percent. A cream-and-teal bracelet with a thin gold line is 60-30-10 in action. This simple split creates balance, keeps designs calm and makes it easy to calculate how many beads of each color to buy.

Six palettes to start with. Each has a name, a mood and a suggested bead mix. Colors are described by family so you can match them to whatever your supplier offers.

Palette	Mood	60 / 30 / 10 mix	Good for
Morning Linen	Calm, natural, everyday	Soft cream / warm taupe / matte gold	Work and casual wear, gifts
Sea Glass	Fresh, airy, coastal	Pale aqua / sage green / silver	Summer, spring weddings
Dusty Rose Garden	Romantic, gentle	Muted pink / warm cream / bronze	Mother's Day, bridal gifts
Midnight Ink	Elegant, bold	Deep navy / charcoal / metallic silver	Evening wear, men's and unisex styles
Terracotta Sunset	Warm, earthy, artisan	Rust / sand / mustard	Autumn, craft fairs
Berry Bloom	Playful, vibrant	Plum / raspberry / pale lilac	Birthdays, statement pieces

Why these work. All six keep the main color quiet, the support color gentle and the accent small. That is why they photograph well and why customers say, "it goes with everything." You can mix and match: Morning Linen as a base with a Terracotta accent, for example.

Seasonal palettes. Seasonal pieces give buyers a reason to buy now. Plan them a few weeks early so the pieces are ready when people start looking.

12. Color Palettes That Sell (continued)

Season	Palette direction	Example accent
Spring	Soft pastels, light greens, creams	Pale yellow or lilac
Summer	Aqua, coral, sunny neutrals	Metallic gold
Autumn	Rust, mustard, olive, sand	Copper
Winter holidays	Deep red, forest green, ivory, silver	Gold or icy white
Wedding season	Ivory, blush, sage, champagne	Pearl-effect or silver

Testing a palette before stitching. Lay a few beads of each color on a white sheet of paper, in the proportions of 60-30-10, and look at them in daylight and under your lamp. Colors shift under different lights. Take a photograph and view it on your phone, since many buyers will see your piece on a phone screen. If the photo looks muddy, increase the contrast between the dominant and support colors, or add a metallic accent.

- Too many colors: stick to three or four in one piece.
- Colors too similar in value (all medium tone): add a very light and a very dark bead so the pattern is visible.
- Thread showing: match the thread color to the dominant bead.
- Metallic overload: use metallic as the 10 percent accent, not the base.

> **TIP: NAME YOUR PALETTES**
> A palette called "Sea Glass" sells better than "light blue and green." Names are free, memorable and make your pieces feel like a collection. Use the same name on your tags, photos and listings.

Practice task: build your signature trio

Choose three palettes from the table and write their bead color names or codes next to them. Check which beads you already own. Circle the palette you can start with using the least additional purchase. That palette becomes your first mini collection.

13. Pricing Basics: Materials, Time, Overhead and Profit

Pricing is where many makers feel uncomfortable. It does not have to be. A fair price is built from four parts: materials, your time, overhead and profit. When you add them in order, the price stops being a guess. The Price Calculator in your set is a worksheet that does the arithmetic with you, and this chapter explains the logic.

The formula in plain words: Price = materials + time + overhead + profit. Think of each part:

- Materials: every bead, the thread, the findings, the packaging. Divide the cost of a package by the number you can make from it. For example, if a tube of beads costs $4 and gives you enough for four pieces, the cost per piece is $1.
- Time: how many hours you spend, times an hourly rate you set for yourself. You can start with a modest rate and raise it as your speed and demand grow.
- Overhead: the small costs that exist even if you make nothing: tools, platform fees, photography supplies, packaging, shipping materials. A simple way to include overhead is to add a percentage, such as 10 to 20 percent of materials and time.
- Profit: the amount that lets your craft business grow, buy new supplies and stay healthy. Many makers add 10 to 30 percent as a starting point.

> **IMPORTANT**
> The prices below are only worked examples to show the method. They are not a promise of what you will earn or what buyers will pay. Check current fees, taxes and local rules for where you live and sell.

Example calculations for four pieces. We use an hourly rate of $12 for the examples and 15 percent overhead; your numbers will differ.

Piece	Materials	Time	Time cost at $12/h	Overhead 15%	Profit 20%	Suggested price
Slim zigzag bracelet	$4.50	6 h	$72.00	$11.48	$17.60	about $105
Pair of drop earrings	$2.80	3 h	$36.00	$5.82	$8.96	about $54
Beaded band ring	$1.50	2 h	$24.00	$3.83	$5.87	about $35
Gift set (bracelet + earrings)	$7.30	9 h	$108.00	$17.30	$26.46	about $159

Look at that table and you will see a hard truth: if you pay yourself fairly for time, handmade beadwork is not cheap. Many makers choose a lower hourly rate while they are learning or quickly increase their speed. Others reduce time by choosing simpler designs, narrower widths or repeatable patterns. Either choice is honest. What matters is that you know the true cost and choose your price on purpose.

Typical ranges for similar pieces. Handmade seed-bead bracelets and earrings are commonly listed across a wide range depending on width, complexity and the maker's reputation. A slim, simple bracelet might be listed in the tens of dollars, and intricate or wide cuffs in the higher range. These are examples of what people list, not a promise of what your pieces will fetch. Look at similar items yourself and set your own price.

13. Pricing Basics: Materials, Time, Overhead and Profit (continued)

Pricing approach	How it works	Good when
Cost-plus	Add up costs, then add profit	You want a clear, defensible price
Market check	Look at similar listings	You want to avoid being far out of range
Tiered line	Simple pieces at a lower price, complex at a higher price	You want choices for different budgets
Set pricing	Small discount for a bracelet and earrings together	You want to raise the average order

TIP: PRICE IN A PATTERN

Make a short price list: slim bracelet, wide bracelet, earrings, set. Use the same prices across your shop so customers understand your logic. Change prices only when your costs change or demand clearly supports it.

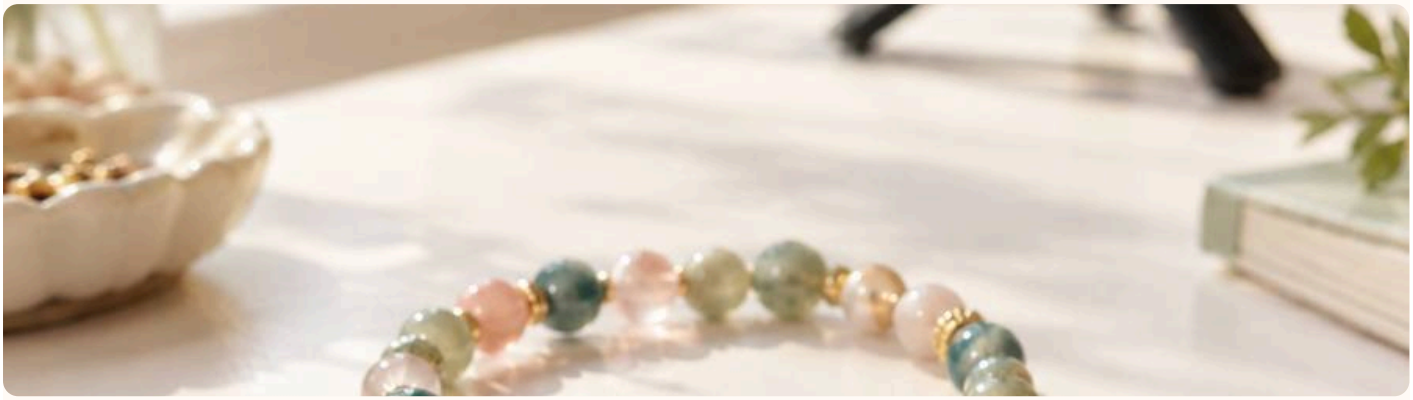
TIP: DO NOT FORGET SHIPPING AND FEES

If you sell online, decide whether shipping is included in the price or charged separately. Marketplaces and payment services charge fees that change; check the current fees before you set your price.

Practice task: price your first bracelet

Open the Price Calculator bonus. Enter the bead cost per piece, your time in hours and your hourly rate. Add 15 percent overhead and your chosen profit. Write down the price, then compare it to three similar listings. Adjust your design or your price, not your honesty about the costs.

14. Presenting, Packaging and Photographing Your Work



A beautiful piece can be overlooked if it is photographed under a dim lamp or tossed into a plain bag. Presentation tells the buyer, before they read a word, that the piece is cared for. The Photos That Sell guide in your set gives step-by-step lighting and styling setups; this chapter gives you the basics you can apply right away.

Photographing with a phone. You do not need a camera. A phone and daylight are enough.

- Use soft daylight from a window. Avoid direct sun, which creates harsh shadows and washes out colors.
- Place the piece on a simple background: white card, linen or a pale wooden board. The background should not compete with the beads.
- Take photos from straight above and from a slight angle. Add one photo of the clasp and one showing scale, such as on a wrist or next to a coin.
- Wipe the lens. A smudge is the most common reason for dull photos.
- Edit lightly: crop, brighten a little and check that the colors are true. If your photo does not look like the real piece, buyers will notice.

Photo	What it shows	Why it matters
Hero	The whole piece, clean background	The first image people see
Detail	Close-up of the pattern	Shows craft quality
On wrist or ear	Real-life scale	Helps buyers imagine wearing it
Clasp	The closure and finish	Builds trust
Lifestyle	Piece in a natural setting	Gives a mood and a story

Writing a description. Use three short lines: what it is, what it is made of, and what size it is. Add the palette name and a one-line story. Be clear about care: "Handmade with Miyuki Delica seed beads and nylon beading thread. Please keep away from water and perfume." Avoid overselling; honest descriptions earn happy customers.

14. Presenting, Packaging and Photographing Your Work (continued)

Packaging that feels special. You do not need a big budget. A small kraft box or an organza pouch, a piece of tissue, a printed care card and a thank-you note create a memorable unboxing.

- A small box or pouch that fits the piece snugly.
- Tissue paper in the palette's accent color.
- A care card with the palette name and care tips.
- A short thank-you note, handwritten if you can, with no personal contact details added unless you intend to include them for your business.
- A mailer with cardboard stiffener for shipping.

> **TIP: KEEP IT CONSISTENT**
> Use the same background, the same lighting and the same angle for your photos. A consistent look makes your shop feel like a brand, even when you are one person with a window.

> **TIP: PROTECT THE PIECE**
> Slide the bracelet around a small roll of tissue so it holds its shape, and avoid pressing the beads against rough surfaces in transit.

Practice task: one complete photo set

Choose your finished bracelet. Take the five photos from the table in daylight. Select the best three. Write a three-line description and name the palette. Put the piece in its packaging and photograph the closed box. Save everything in a folder named with the piece's name.

15. Getting Your First Orders



Selling is not about being pushy. It is about letting the right people see what you made. Your first orders will most likely come from the people closest to you, and then from a slowly widening circle. Here is a calm plan for each channel. The From Jewelry to Your Own Small Business bonus goes deeper on the practical side.

Start with people you know. Family and friends are your first audience. Give them a small gift, or offer a simple order at a fair price, and ask for an honest opinion and a photo of them wearing it. Do not pressure anyone. A real photo is worth far more than a polished one.

Craft fairs and markets. These are wonderful for first sales, because buyers can touch the piece, and you get immediate feedback. Start small: a shared table or a local community market. Bring 12 to 20 pieces across a few price points, a small mirror, a tidy display and a simple way to take payment. Check local rules for stalls, permits and sales tax before you go.

Instagram and social platforms. Post your process as well as your finished pieces: close-ups of rows, short videos of stitching, a palette laid out on a table. People like to watch things being made. Use a clear name and your palette names, reply to comments warmly and keep your messages and orders inside the platform rather than sharing personal details.

Etsy and other marketplaces. A marketplace shop gives you built-in search traffic, but also competition and fees. Check current listing fees, transaction fees and rules before you open a shop. Start with five or six well-photographed listings, using clear titles that mention the type of piece, the beads and the color, for example "Delicate beaded bracelet, seed bead peyote, cream and teal."

Wholesale basics. When a small boutique or gift shop shows interest, wholesale means selling pieces to the shop at a lower price so they can add their own markup. A common approach is to set a retail price that works and a wholesale price that is a fraction of it. Do this only after you are sure you can make pieces consistently and on time, because boutiques expect reliability. Ask them about their payment terms, return policy and display needs. Check the rules for where you live.

15. Getting Your First Orders (continued)

Channel	Effort to start	Strength	Watch out for
Family and friends	Very low	Honest feedback, quick first sales	Underpricing out of kindness
Craft fair	Medium	Touch and try, direct buyers	Stall fees, travel, weather
Instagram	Low to medium	Process content, local reach	Time spent posting
Etsy or marketplace	Medium	Search traffic	Fees, competition
Wholesale	Higher	Repeat orders	Consistent quality, lower margins

> **TIP: START WITH THREE PRICES**
> Offer three clear options: a small piece, a medium piece and a set. This makes choosing easy and gently raises the average order. Keep stock of your three best-selling palettes.

> **TIP: COLLECT KIND WORDS**
> Ask happy buyers if they would be comfortable leaving a short review. Reviews build trust faster than any advertising.

Be honest about expectations. The first orders may come slowly, and some weeks may bring none. That is normal. Selling is a skill, like stitching, and it improves with repetition. If you keep making pieces you love and sharing them kindly, your audience grows. Whether you sell a lot or a little, you will have created something lovely with your own hands.

- Checklist: before your first sale, you know your price, your packaging, your photos, how you will take payment, and how you will ship or deliver.
- Checklist: keep a simple notebook of every order: date, piece, price, materials cost and buyer feedback.

Practice task: your first three offers

Write down three people or places you could offer a piece to this month (a friend, a coworker, a local market). For each, note which piece you would offer and a price. Do not send anything yet; the 30-day plan will tell you when to reach out.

16. Your 30-Day Action Plan and Troubleshooting Quick List



This plan turns everything you have read into small weekly steps. It is deliberately gentle; if life gets busy, shift the weeks, but keep the order. Pick up your sticky note from Chapter 1 and see how it fits.

Week	Focus	What to do	Done when
Week 1	Learn and prepare	Read Chapters 1 to 6; buy your starter kit; make the three stitch samples (Chapter 7); finish the 20-row peyote sampler (Chapter 8)	You can read a chart and have your tools ready
Week 2	First bracelet	Stitch the first bracelet (Chapter 10), add the clasp (Chapter 9), tug test and photograph	One finished, wearable bracelet
Week 3	Expand	Make matching earrings (Chapter 11), choose your palette (Chapter 12), complete the Price Calculator (Chapter 13)	A small set and a price list
Week 4	Show and share	Photograph and package (Chapter 14), offer to three people, post one process video, list or set up your first channel (Chapter 15)	Your first offer is out in the world

Daily rhythm. Beading 30 to 45 minutes a day beats a marathon once a week. Keep your kit in a box so you can start in under a minute. Many beaders find that a short, regular habit is what turns a half-finished project into a finished collection.

- Day 1 to 3: set up your workspace, buy the kit, make the sample card.
- Day 4 to 7: ladder, brick and square samples; start the peyote sampler.
- Day 8 to 14: first bracelet.
- Day 15 to 21: earrings and the price calculation.
- Day 22 to 26: photos and packaging.
- Day 27 to 30: first offers and a review of what worked.

Practice task: a Sunday review

At the end of each week, write three lines: what I finished, what was hard, what I will do next week. Keep these notes together. After 30 days you will have a clear record of your progress and a list of what to improve.

Troubleshooting quick list. Most problems have simple fixes. Keep this list open while you bead. The Fix-It troubleshooting guide in your set goes deeper, with step-by-step solutions.

16. Your 30-Day Action Plan and Troubleshooting Quick List (continued)

Problem	Likely cause	Quick fix
Thread keeps tangling	Thread too long or no conditioner	Use 4 to 5 feet and condition the thread
Piece is stiff or curls	Tension too tight	Loosen your pull slightly and keep it consistent
Thread shows between beads	Tension too loose	Pull a little firmer after each stitch
Rows are uneven or wavy	Uneven tension or miscounted beads	Count rows and compare edges every 10 rows
Needle will not pass through a bead	Bead is too small or hole is blocked	Use a thinner needle or skip the bead
Beads are different sizes	Mixed lots or brands	Sort and discard odd beads, use one lot
Thread is fraying	Passing through the same beads many times	Re-thread with fresh thread, use a fused line
Pattern looks wrong	Misread chart or lost place	Mark rows and compare to the chart every 5 rows
Clasp feels loose	Too few thread passes	Add extra passes through the loop
Colors look different than expected	Light or lot differences	Check under daylight and buy from one lot

> **TIP: WHEN IN DOUBT, STOP AND LOOK**
> If something feels wrong, put the needle down and compare your work to the chart. Mistakes found early cost seconds; mistakes found after 20 rows cost an evening. And if a section cannot be fixed, you can carefully pick it out bead by bead and begin again. Every beader has done it.

- Quick checklist before you finish any piece: edges smooth, tension even, colors match the palette, closure tugged, tails woven in, care card ready.
- Quick checklist before you sell any piece: price calculated, photos taken, description written, packaging ready.

Next steps

You have now seen the whole path: why delicate seed-bead jewelry sells, what to buy, how to read a chart, how to stitch, how to finish, how to choose colors, how to price, how to photograph and how to find your first customers. None of it requires talent you do not already have. It requires small, patient, repeated steps.

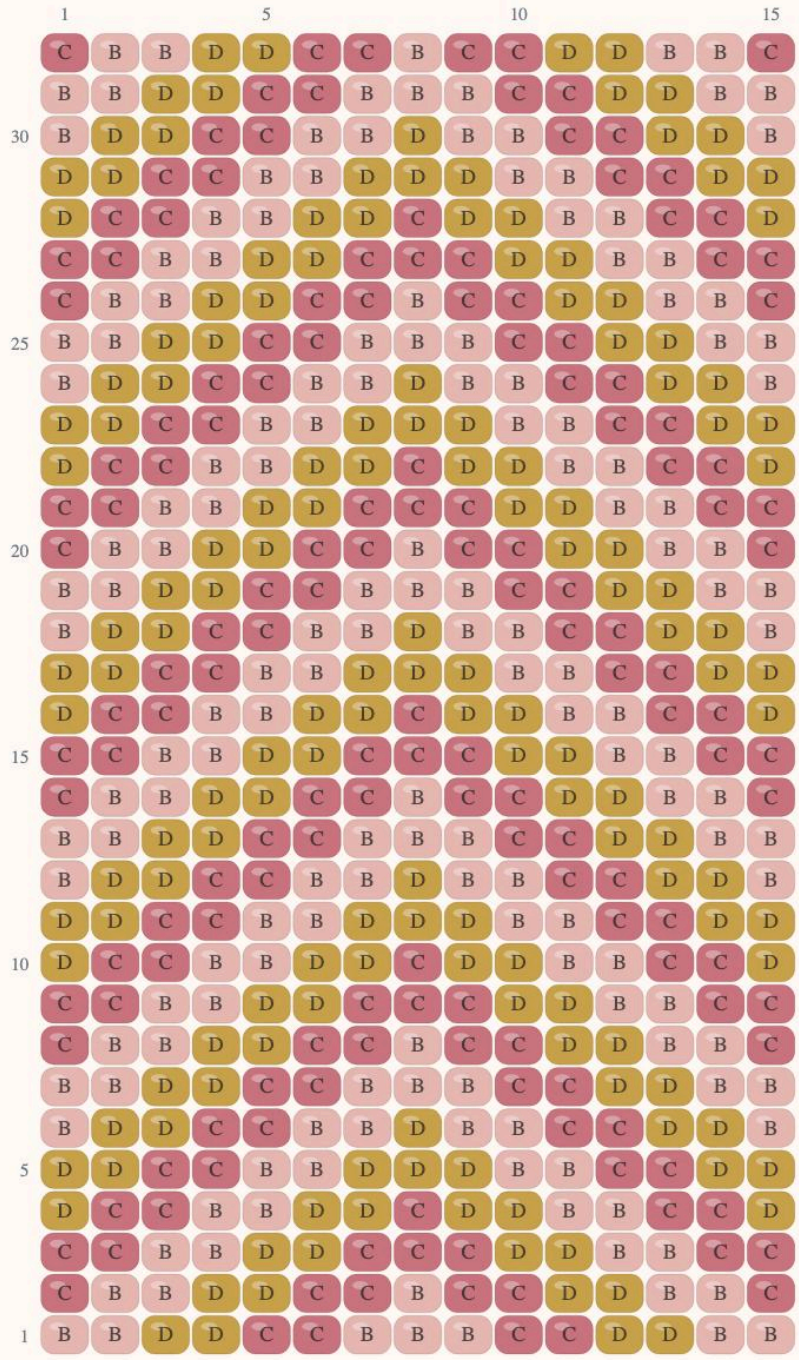
Keep your sampler swatches, your sticky note and your first bracelet. Months from now they will remind you where you began. Return to the 50 Best-Selling Patterns when you want your next piece, to the Price Calculator when you set a price, and to the Fix-It guide when something goes wrong.

Remember that all prices and results in this guide are examples, not promises. Your path will be your own. Be kind to yourself, keep your tension even, and enjoy the quiet pleasure of making something beautiful by hand. Happy beading!

1. Blush Chevron Bracelet

Blush & Gold palette · Loom · 15 × 32 beads (one repeat)

STITCH	CHART SIZE	TIME (APPROX.)	TYPICAL LISTING RANGE
Loom	15 × 32 beads	7.3–10.5 h	$24–$48



	Color	Count
	B · Matte blush	162 beads
	C · Rose	160 beads
	D · Metallic gold	158 beads

Total: Repeat the chart 4× for a 7-in. bracelet (≈112 rows, 1680 beads).

Weave on a bead loom: row 1 at the bottom, work upward. Every row is one pass of beads.

Swap colors freely: keep the same dark/light order and the pattern holds.

RECOLOR IDEAS

Lavender Haze

Midnight Silver

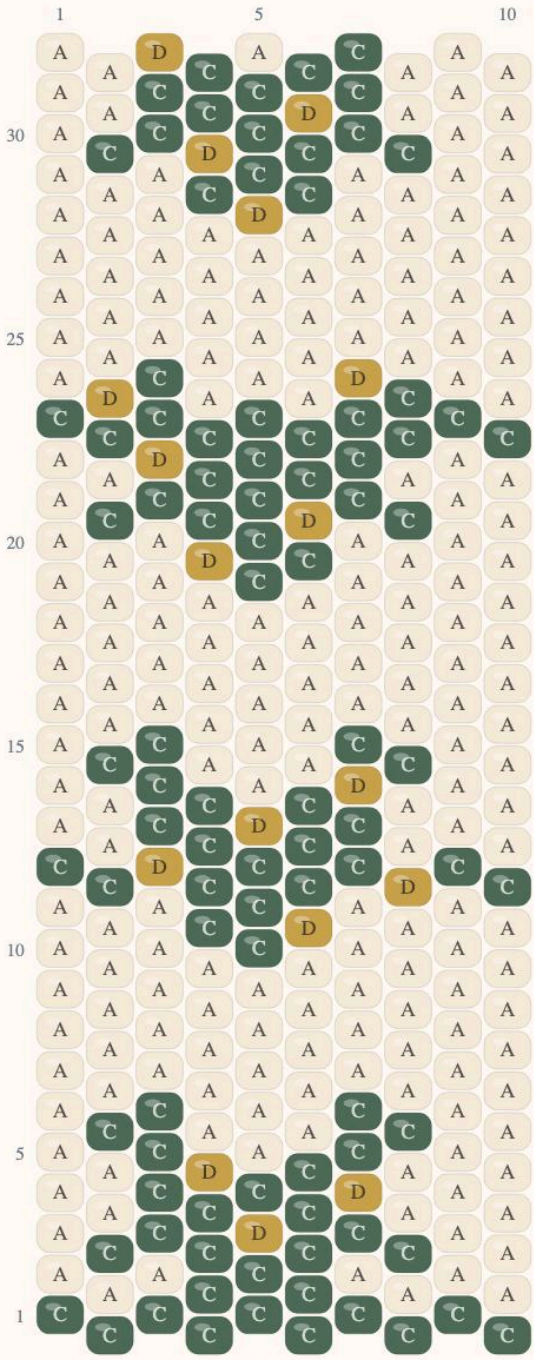
Terracotta Sand

Listing ranges are examples of what similar handmade pieces are listed for, not a promise of sales. Use the Price Calculator bonus for your own numbers.

2. Sage Stars Bracelet

Sage Garden palette · Peyote · 10 × 32 beads (one repeat)

STITCH	CHART SIZE	TIME (APPROX.)	TYPICAL LISTING RANGE
Peyote	10 × 32 beads	6.6–10.2 h	$18–$38



Color	Count
A · Cream	210 beads
C · Deep green	93 beads
D · Gold	17 beads

Total: Repeat the chart 4× for a 7-in. bracelet (≈112 rows, 1120 beads).

Peyote (brick) layout: alternate columns sit half a bead higher. Row 1 at the bottom.

Swap colors freely: keep the same dark/light order and the pattern holds.

RECOLOR IDEAS

Berry Garden

Forest Moss

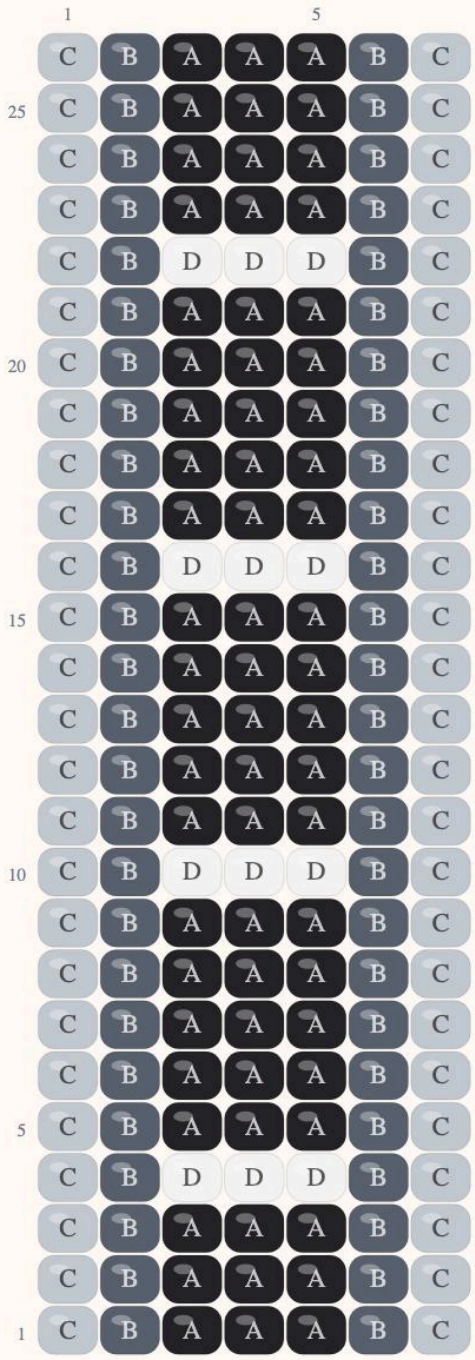
Pearl & Rose

Listing ranges are examples of what similar handmade pieces are listed for, not a promise of sales. Use the Price Calculator bonus for your own numbers.

6. Midnight Border Earrings

Midnight Silver palette · Square stitch · 7 × 26 beads (one repeat)

STITCH	CHART SIZE	TIME (APPROX.)	TYPICAL LISTING RANGE
Square stitch	7 × 26 beads	1.3–2.0 h	$14–$28



Color	Count
A · Black	66 beads
B · Slate	52 beads
C · Silver	52 beads
D · White	12 beads

Total: Make 2 (one per ear): 364 beads for the pair.

Square stitch: beads sit in a straight grid, like a loom chart. Row 1 at the bottom.

Swap colors freely: keep the same dark/light order and the pattern holds.

RECOLOR IDEAS

Pearl & Rose

Denim Daisy

Autumn Spice

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